

Self-Reflection

Generative artificial intelligence has been the talk of the town in creative industries. Despite my research, experimentation and application of it in my most recent work, I fail to grasp the full meaning of generative AI. In this essay, I will demonstrate my current understanding of generative AI and its use cases in creative fields.

Firstly, the concept of generative AI is still vague to me. They say, “A painting is worth a thousand words,” this idiom suggests that the artist pour a part of their soul into every work that they make, giving it countless meaning. This begs the question, does AI really have a soul? Does it really have consciousness? Will it become abominable intelligence? These are the questions that have no answer for now. For example, in my recent work made with generative AI “Gen_collage2.png,” the naïve looking space-doodles and the collages represent a child’s ambitions and dreams of becoming an astronaut. In retrospect, I am still in the fog of it all – generative AI.

Secondly, generative AI has countless uses cases in creative fields. In photography, it can be used to generatively modify a picture. For example, Adobe Firefly – the generative AI use in photoshop – the generative fills to fill the image with user-inputted prompt, it can also resize an image by filling in the missing space with algorithmically predicted image generation. Moreover, in content creation, it can be used to create short-form videos in an instant. Case in point, countless bot accounts on TikTok, YouTube, and Instagram hosting Reddit story videos accompanied by Minecraft parkour, Subway Surfer gameplay or a cooking backdrop. This goes to show there are innumerable ways to utilize generative AI in creative fields.

One of the generative AI works that inspires me is Refik Anadol’s Unsupervised — Machine Hallucinations. I find it interesting because it transforms data into “autonomous machine hallucinations”. The artwork feels like an inter-dimensional overlap between reality and imagination, creating constantly changing unpredictable forms. It surprises me by how generative AI can interpret existing data into something abstract, immersive, and chaotic.